# The 720: China AI, CATL, HSBC, AIA, HK Ex, Inovance, Korea Banks, Largan, WUS, SG Banks, Shein

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**In Focus | China AI**

China Strategy – AI Changes The Game: China is coming. We believe a global AI duopoly is emerging as China builds an increasingly self-sufficient, internally-circulated AI ecosystem to complement its pivotal role as a global supply chain exporter. With Chinese AI-related total addressable market share projected to reach US$3-4tn by 2030 at a 28% compound annual growth rate, domestic technological gaps with the West are narrowing across foundational domains like advanced semiconductors, open-weight models, and physical AI applications. To monetize this theme, we prefer a diversified approach that balances Chinese AI Export Leaders offering compelling growth against geopolitical risks, Domestic Chinese AI Champions benefiting from robust local capex and policy support, and our refreshed 50-stock China Select AI Portfolio spanning the entire value chain. *Kinger Lau*

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China in Motion: Macro & Strategy | 10am HK | Global Macro, Exports Outlook, Market Views | Access Webinar | with Xinquan Chen, Yuting Yang, Chelsea Song, Kinger Lau, Si Fu & Kevin Wang (in Mandarin)

India Macro to Micro: RBI Tightening Cycle & Banks Earnings Outlook | 4pm HK | Access Webinar | with Santanu Sengupta, Sumeet Kariwala, Michael Snaith

**Previews | CATL, HSBC,AIA, HK Ex, Inovance, Korea Banks, SEMCO, India Metals & Mining**

CATL – 3Q26 Preview: Robust volume, but unit margin in focus – Buy (on CL). Ahead of 3Q26 results, we forecast net profit of Rmb24bn (+30% yoy) driven by robust sales volume of 260GWh, though we expect unit net profit to decline sequentially to Rmb93/kWh. We trim our 2026E-28E EPS estimates by 1-2% as higher volume forecasts are offset by more conservative unit margin assumptions, and lower our 12m TPs to HK$859 for H-shares and Rmb559 for A-shares. We see the energy storage system mix, raw-material inventory impairment losses, and the pass-through of the reinstated battery consumption tax as the key swing factors for the quarter. *Nick Zheng*

HSBC – Steady 3Q26 Expected with Focus on NII and Buybacks – Buy (on CL). We expect 3Q26 underlying PBT of US$10.4bn, 2% ahead of consensus, supported by

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healthy balance sheet expansion, a higher rate environment, and broadly stable credit costs. Offsetting this, we anticipate moderating non-banking NII following a robust second quarter, and forecast a reduced US$0.5bn share buyback reflecting continued loan growth alongside negative OCI impacts from steeper yield curves. We revise our FY26E–FY29E EPS estimates to reflect stronger loan growth balanced by higher opex investments, adjusting our 12m TP for 0005.HK to HK$192 while keeping HSBA.L unchanged at 1,860p. *Melissa Kuang*

AIA Group – 3Q26 Preview: VONB Declines on Base Effect, Growth to Recover in 4Q – Buy. We reiterate Buy and lower our 12m TP to HK$95 from HK$96, as we expect 3Q26 Value of New Business (VONB) to decline 3% year over year on a constant exchange rate basis due to high base effects from previous sales promotions in Hong Kong, Mainland China, and Thailand. We believe recent share price weakness, driven by investor concerns over slowing Chinese consumer demand amid offshore tax collection headlines, provides an attractive entry point because the underlying structural growth trend remains intact. Despite the temporary third-quarter decline, our estimates imply strong 2-year CAGRs across key markets, and we expect VONB to recover to double-digit growth in 4Q26E and into FY27E. *Thomas Wang*

Hong Kong Exchanges – 3Q26 Preview: Profit to Decline Amid Subdued Trading Activity – Buy. We lower our 12m TP to HK$523 from HK$532 and trim FY26E-29E EPS estimates by 1-2% to reflect a slowdown in recent market activity. Ahead of 3Q26 results on November 6, we expect EPS of HK$3.76, marking a 3% yoy decline driven by weaker Average Daily Turnover (ADT) and lower investment income. ADT eased 11% yoy to HK$254bn due to tech stock weakness and a 30% drop in southbound turnover, while we model a 23% qoq decline in investment income stemming from margin fund contraction. Moving forward, investors will likely focus on the ADT outlook, potential trading hour extensions, and new gold market initiatives, although we note the IPO pipeline remains robust with 577 companies currently under processing. *Thomas Wang*

Inovance Technology – 3Q26 Preview: Stable quarter but moderating IA growth prompts TP cut – Buy. We preview 3Q26 results with revenue and net profit forecasts of +18% and +20% yoy, respectively, but lower our 12m TP to Rmb75.9 from Rmb89.2 on moderating Industrial Automation (IA) order growth. We cut our 2026E–2030E EPS by 1–2% to reflect a weaker battery capex outlook and slowing AI capex, though we expect sequential gross margin stability and contained EV component losses. We remain constructive, viewing a faster ramp in embodied AI, accelerated digitalization revenue, and global market share gains amid international supply chain tightness as key upside optionalities. *Jacqueline Du*

South Korea Banks – 3Q26E Preview. We remain constructive on the sector and reiterate our Buy ratings on KB, Shinhan, Hana, IBK and BNK, despite expecting 3Q26 earnings to miss consensus by 7% amid slower fee-income growth and near-term margin headwinds. We trim our FY26E–FY28E earnings estimates by 1–3% and our 12m TPs by 1–2% on average, though we anticipate a visible net interest margin expansion beginning in 4Q26 as asset repricing comfortably overrides lingering funding-cost pressures. Furthermore, a sharp won appreciation during the quarter provides a sizable CET1 capital buffer tailwind, easing the risk-weighted asset burden and improving flexibility to sustain shareholder returns. With valuations undemanding after a recent pullback, disciplined cost controls and robust loan growth should help banks maintain a solid 10% ROE. *Sinyoung Park*

Samsung Electro-Mechanics – AI tailwinds driving MLCC and ABF OP beat – Buy. We raise our 3Q26 OP estimate by 12% to W670bn and lift our 12m TP to W2,400,000, as strong AI demand for MLCCs and FC-BGA substrates more than offsets currency headwinds. We increase our 2026E-28E EPS estimates by 11-21%, driven by a higher AI MLCC revenue mix and favorable ASPs amid ongoing supply tightness, prompting us to raise MLCC operating margin forecasts to 20-37% for the period. Additionally, we upgrade substrate segment OP expectations by 10-18% through 2028, reflecting near-full FC-BGA utilization and margin expansion from higher-complexity AI datacenter products. *Giuni Lee*

India Metals & Mining – Q2FY27 preview: A challenging quarter, but operating outlook turns better. We expect a challenging Q2FY27 for covered metal companies due to lower realizations and higher coking coal costs compressing spreads, though steel sales volumes should increase sequentially on the back of inventory liquidation and rising exports. Going forward, we anticipate profitability to improve in H2FY27 driven by recent steel price hikes of USD 40-45/t and seasonal volume strength, prompting us to raise our FY27E EBITDA estimate for JSW Steel by 7.2% while making minor adjustments across the broader group. Although adverse macro factors may keep medium-term stock performance subdued, we maintain Jindal Stainless, JSW Steel, and Shyam Metalics as our key Buy-rated preferred picks in the space. *Amit Dixit*

**Themes in Play | Largan, WUS, Singapore Banks, Data Centers**

Largan – FAU Expansion to Drive Growth and Re-rating – Buy. We maintain our Buy rating and raise our 12m TP to NT$11,000 from NT$6,263, driven by the company's strong alignment technology supporting its expansion into Fiber Arrays (FA) and Fiber Array Units (FAU) for CPO switches. While a slower smartphone market and delayed handset lens pixel mix upgrades prompted us to revise 2026E-28E net income estimates by -13%, -4%, and +16% respectively, we expect gross margins to sustain at roughly 50%. Management highlights strong customer qualification feedback and a preference for integrated FA and FAU products, which we model to reach over 50% of revenue by 2030E, supporting significant earnings growth and a valuation re-rating. *Verena Jeng*

WUS – AI PCB ramp-up drives earnings and margin upgrades – Buy. We maintain our Buy rating and raise our 12m TP to Rmb148 from Rmb142, driven by rising AI PCB demand from server and switch specification upgrades. We revise up 2026E–28E earnings by 8%/4%/4% and gross margin estimates by 1.5ppts/0.6ppts/0.8ppts to reflect a product mix upgrade toward higher-margin, higher-layer data center PCBs. For 3Q26E, we expect sequential revenue growth of 5% to Rmb7.8bn and gross margin expansion to 37.6% as new capacity in China and Thailand ramps up to support stronger client orders. *Verena Jeng*

Singapore Banks – Key debates after the recent sell-off. We believe the recent 7-10% sell-off in Singapore banks is overdone, as our bear-case stress test of five key industry concerns suggests much of the downside is already priced in. While acknowledging near-term pressure from deposit competition, gradual mortgage repricing, and cyclical wealth transaction softness, we view these as manageable mark-to-market headwinds rather than a structural deterioration in returns. Across our sensitivities, we see UOB as most exposed to deposit and mortgage repricing, OCBC as facing the most relevant capital debate given its lower starting CET1, and DBS as relatively better insulated. *Melissa Kuang*

China Data Centers – Following the ROIC. We believe the China Data Center sector is transitioning from a traditional capacity growth story into a capital-allocation story, where generating return on invested capital (ROIC) above the cost of capital is increasingly prioritized following recent US rate hikes. While traditional powered shells remain lower-return assets with a base-case ROIC of approximately 5%, return potential rises significantly as operators move closer to AI workload monetization through integrated AI data centers and token factories, although execution, technology, and earnings risks increase accordingly. Within the space, we highlight Buy-rated GDS Holdings, VNET Group, and Range Intelligent for their clear pathways to ROIC expansion via REIT asset recycling and advancing up the AI infrastructure value chain, while remaining cautious on Neutral-rated Athub and Sell-rated Sinnet due to traditional business growth pressures. *Timothy Zhao*

GS SUSTAIN – APAC Data Centers: From Commitments to Capacity. We see the key debate around AI infrastructure shifting from capacity commitments to capacity conversion, as global data center buildouts increasingly face hard bottlenecks like grid connectivity and emerging constraints including water and labor availability. We believe suppliers of critical infrastructure components, such as power equipment and optical networking, alongside enablers of mitigation technologies like advanced liquid cooling and water recycling, are best positioned to benefit from these dynamics. Consequently, we highlight 53 Buy-rated global beneficiaries, spotlighting Conviction List names Shengyi, Weichai Power, and Panasonic HD, as well as Vertiv and Envicool as key cooling enablers for APAC data centers. *Xavier Zhang*

**Results | Yaskawa Electric, Avenue Supermarts**

Yaskawa Electric – 2Q Beats Expectations Amid Supply Chain Focus – Buy. 2Q operating profit of ¥13.6 bn and orders of ¥185.4 bn both exceeded our estimates, prompting us to raise our full-year operating profit forecast to ¥57.0 bn from ¥55.0 bn. Although the company lowered its full-year guidance to ¥57.5 bn due to lingering ERP-related production constraints, the revised outlook still beat consensus. Management struck a subdued tone, which we believe stems from uncertainty around second-half component procurement and intensifying advance ordering across the broader factory automation industry. We maintain our 12m TP of ¥5,500 as we closely monitor the company's ability to navigate these supply-demand imbalances and sustain its brisk order momentum. *Yuichiro Isayama*

Avenue Supermarts – 2Q PBT Miss on Front-Loaded Store Costs – Sell. Following a 2Q standalone PBT miss driven by rising front-loaded costs, we cut our FY27E–FY29E EPS estimates by ~2% and lower our 12m TP to Rs3,500. The earnings drag stems from accelerated store additions—growing ~19–20% YoY—which have pushed operating expenses up faster than revenues and sharply increased D&A and finance costs due to newly rented stores and higher debt funding. Furthermore, we expect same-store sales growth to remain pressured as competitive intensity from quick commerce and larger retail players rises in major cities. *Arnab Mitra*

**GS Event | Shein, Anjoy Foods**

SHEIN – Cautiously optimistic on US recovery and EU local fulfillment ramp – Buy. We maintain our Buy rating and 12m TP of HK$62 following an NDR where management highlighted a continued US revenue recovery, which is expected to return to positive

year-over-year growth in the fourth quarter. While new parcel duties and handling fees are creating near-term demand headwinds in Europe, management expects local fulfillment to ramp to approximately 50% by year-end, mitigating tariff exposure and significantly shortening delivery times. We believe the company remains well-positioned to balance growth and profitability into 2027, supported by easing ex-tariff fulfillment costs, stable margins under a cost-plus pricing framework, and a reiterated commitment to distribute at least 50% of net profits. *Michelle Cheng*

Anjoy Foods Group – Healthy 3Q26 Momentum and Margin Resilience – Buy (H) / Neutral (A). We remain constructive on Anjoy following a recent management NDR, maintaining our Buy rating on the H-shares (12m TP HK$86) and Neutral on the A-shares (12m TP Rmb92) driven by encouraging September sales momentum that outperformed expectations. Management noted that core business operations remained broadly healthy in 3Q26, aided by distributor inventory stocking ahead of phased October price increases designed to mitigate rising surimi and chicken costs. The company is executing a measured "raise-and-monitor" pricing strategy and leveraging its robust supply chain advantages to defend margins, while a strategic Indonesian partnership is set to accelerate long-term overseas channel access. *Valerie Zhou*

**Data Trackers | China Cosmetics**

China Cosmetics – Monthly tracker Sep-26: Slowdown on Double 11 shift. We observe September online beauty GMV growth decelerating to 5% yoy from 8% in July-August, as Douyin's 9% growth partially offset a 4% decline across Tmall and Taobao ahead of a shorter Double 11 promotional period. Channel checks indicate local beauty brands will continue to outgrow multinational peers, which are increasingly prioritizing profitability, amid a broader platform shift toward AI support, KOL livestreaming, and greater merchant rebates. Within the sector, we continue to favor Buy-rated local leaders including Proya for its expected second-half acceleration, alongside MGP, Giant Biogene, and Forest Cabin for their sustained growth momentum and balanced channel development. *Valerie Zhou*

**Asia Macro | China Fiscal policy**

China – MOF Approves Additional RMB550bn Bond Issuance Quota. We expect government bond issuance and the deployment of proceeds to accelerate following the Ministry of Finance's approval of an additional RMB550bn local government bond issuance quota carried over from previous years. Coupled with the RMB800bn New Policy-Based Financial Instrument and unused budget quotas, we estimate roughly RMB5tn in fiscal capacity remains available for the fourth quarter. We believe these incremental measures represent targeted, measured easing intended to secure this year's 4.5–5.0% growth target rather than a sustained, broad-based stimulus cycle. Assuming this funding is fully deployed by year-end, we expect China's augmented fiscal deficit to widen modestly and ease the growth drag from earlier fiscal tightening. *Lisheng Wang*

**New | Sonic Healthcare downgrade**

Australia Healthcare – Limited credit risk but rising yields constrain SHL growth. We review the implications of rising bond yields across our coverage and downgrade Sonic Healthcare (SHL) to Neutral from Buy, lowering our 12m TP to A$19.20. Anticipating elevated debt costs from SHL's high floating rate exposure, alongside back-office

investments and funding cut risks, we forecast a deferral of bolt-on acquisitions that reduces our FY28E and FY29E EPS estimates by 4% and 7%, respectively. Conversely, we expect limited earnings impact for Ramsay Health Care, CSL, and Integral Diagnostics given their prudent hedging policies and higher proportions of fixed debt, retaining our Buy ratings on the former two and Neutral on the latter. *Davin Thillainathan*

**Around the world | Oil, US Strategy, Global FX & Rates**

Oil – Supply Adaptation Meets Global Restocking Demand. We raise our Brent and WTI December 2026 price forecasts to $90/bbl and $81/bbl (from $85 and $80, respectively) as ongoing geopolitical supply risks slow the moderation of the timespreads risk premium. We maintain our 2027 average Brent forecast at $80/bbl and lower WTI to $73/bbl (from $75), balancing downward price pressure from faster-than-expected Persian Gulf supply adaptation against strong physical restocking demand driven by low global inventories. While our base case assumes the global liquids market shifts to a surplus from the fourth quarter of 2026 through 2027, price risks remain significantly tilted to the upside near-term due to potential escalation and infrastructure damage. To hedge these risks, we recommend long summer 2027 European gasoline positions for investors and put spreads for oil producers. *Daan Struyven*

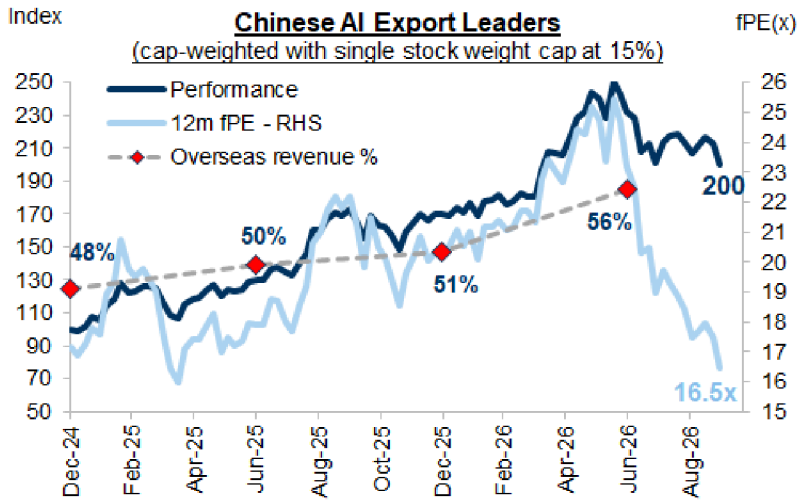
US Strategy – The outlook for corporate equity supply and demand in 2027. We forecast US corporate primary equity issuance will reach $600 billion in 2027, driven by solid economic growth, ongoing AI infrastructure investments, and a projected decline in 10-year Treasury yields from 5.2% to 4.4%. Resilient corporate demand should help offset this primary supply, with gross buybacks expected to increase to $1.7 trillion next year from $1.5 trillion in 2026. While the net supply of public equity is set to rise by the largest amount since 2000 when factoring in expiring IPO lockups, we do not expect this to derail the broader bull market given our forecast for 11% corporate earnings growth and robust retail and foreign investor demand. *Ben Snider*

Global Rates Trader – Establishing a Foothold. We see a favorable tilt for duration at current elevated yields and find tactical value in fading the recent phase of US 10-year underperformance by receiving 10s on the 5s10s30s SOFR fly. This constructive stance is supported by diminished convexity-related risks, with index-level mortgage convexity now close to zero and asset managers having already significantly reduced their benchmark duration exposure. In Europe, we maintain our 3.25% end-2026 yield forecast for 10-year Bunds as safe-haven asymmetry builds, while we prefer Spanish Bonos over Italian BTPs given unpriced political risks, and note that UK Gilt stability will hinge on avoiding fiscal slippage in the upcoming late-October budget. *William Marshall*

Global FX Trader – The Credit Connection. We believe the US Dollar can break to the strong side of its recent narrow range if tighter financial conditions continue to weigh on global growth, particularly in Europe. We revise our 3-, 6-, and 12-month USD/BRL forecasts lower to 4.70, 4.75, and 4.80 (from 5.20, 5.10, and 5.00), driven by expectations of a tighter fiscal stance following a market-friendly first-round election outcome in Brazil. Elsewhere, we see scope for a tactical recovery in the broad Euro as sovereign credit spread widening appears to have run ahead of fundamentals, though longer-term structural and carry challenges remain. Finally, we recommend long JPY exposure versus EUR to minimize carry costs, and view the INR as our preferred candidate for carry and diversification in Asia given its solid macro outlook. *Kamakshya*

*Trivedi*

**Graphic language |** Chinese AI Export Leaders' valuations have fallen to the low-end of the recent-year range




Source: FactSet, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

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**GS Events** (Home Page here)

- **China Next-Gen Power & Mobility Day | Shenzhen** | 2-4 Nov
- **APAC Healthcare Corporate Day 2026 - Part I | Hong Kong** | 3-6 Nov
- **Korea KRX Kosdaq Corporate Day | Hong Kong & Singapore** | 24-25 Nov
- **India Corporate Day | Hong Kong** | 30 Nov - 1 Dec
- **Japan Conference | Tokyo |** 30 Nov - 4 Dec

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